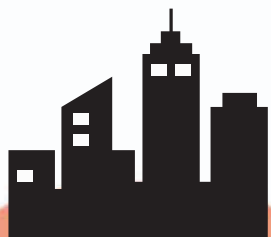


TOWN PLANNER



SALARY

Assistant town planner ★★☆☆☆
Chief planning officer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Jobs dependent on growing population and need for housing • Economic fluctuations affect the rise or fall of planning applications

JOB DESCRIPTION

Shaping the development of towns and cities is a balancing act between the economic and social needs of a community. Environmental concerns and housing, economic development, and cultural and recreational interests are all considered. As a town planner, you must examine and balance these issues, and make a judgment on planning applications proposed by individuals and companies.



CAREER PATHS

After graduation, town planners usually start their careers in local or regional government. With experience, they can progress to more senior planning roles within government agencies, or choose to work with developers and construction firms in the private sector to help them negotiate complex planning regulations.

SENIOR PLANNING OFFICER Takes on complex planning projects, such as landscape conservation and large-scale urban developments. This involves supervising junior staff and keeping on top of larger budgets.



GRADUATE You can start with a town planning degree recognized by a professional planning body. Alternatively, you can study for a degree in geography, architecture, statistics, environmental science, or followed by graduate training in town planning.



TOWN PLANNER Once qualified as a town planner, you will generally start work as an assistant. After gaining experience, you have a choice between several career routes.



PLANNING CONSULTANT Works as a private consultant with property developers, government, charities, and other agencies on a range of major planning projects.

